SIPAH-E-MUHAMMAD PAKISTAN (SMP)

SMP was the militant wing of Tehreek-e-Nifaz-e-Fiqa Jafaria or the Movement for Enforcement of the Shiʿa System, the main-stream Shiʿa organisation of Pakistan headed by Allama Sajid Naqvi. Its origin is attributed much to the Iranian Islamic Revolution and Iranian financial support to all Shiʿa madrasahs of Pakistan. It was led by Ali Reza Naqvi, who was later arrested under charges of murder, kidnapping for ransom and robberies. He is incarcerated in Central Jail Lahore.

After ferocious attacks by SSP and government crackdowns, SMP ceased to exist as all its active members were arrested and incarcerated. However, in 2011, intelligence reports indicated that it was again becoming active after the attacks on Shiʿa in Quetta (Balochistan). The release of LeJ's dreaded leader Malik Muhammad Ishaq in 2011 and his whirlwind tour of Punjab to activate SSP activists, which coincided with attacks on Hazara Shi'a in Quetta, was also a cause of concern for Shiʿas.

During this period, Pakistan had been facing violence, which was not Islamist or sectarian in nature. Rather it was political and was introduced in the port city of Karachi in the mid-1980s by the Muhajir Qaumi Movement (MQM), which emerged as the ethnic party of the muhajir, refugees from the Muslim-majority areas of British India in 1947. In the late 1980s and the 1990s, it resorted to extreme violence. The dead bodies of MQM opponents were frequently found in gunny bags on Karachi's roadsides, and many of the MQM's political rivals blamed these killings on the movement. Several law-enforcement operations also unearthed torture cells run by the MQM.

Intelligence agencies claimed to have proof of its links with India and its design to create a separate state named 'Jinnah Pur'. Altaf Hussain, the supreme leader of MQM, who went in self-exile in London, reportedly had the map of this plan also.[6] It was quelled during the Benazir Bhutto's regime through Operation 'Clean-Up' (July 1995–6) (*The Pakistan Development Review*, 1996). However, it kept erupting in some way. During Musharraf's regime, their strength was restored, as they became part of the government. General Musharraf being an Urdu-speaking Mohajir had ethnic proximity with MQM. He considered them useful political allies to extend his rule and therefore ignored all its evil characters and promoted it. The highlight was the induction of Ishratul Abaad as the Governor Sindh although he was accused in a police case for